- Out-of-network facilities must, prior to admission, agree to abide by the terms established by the Plan for the care of the particular member and for the submission and processing of related claims.

- **Exceptions**

You do not need precertification in these cases:

- You have another group health insurance policy that is the primary payor for the facility stay or other services; or
- Medicare Part A is the primary payor for the facility stay. Note: If you exhaust your Medicare hospital benefits and do not want to use your Medicare lifetime reserve days, then we will become the primary payor, and you **do** need precertification.

Other services

Some surgeries and procedures, drugs, tests, services and equipment require precertification or preauthorization. Specific services requiring preauthorization or precertification are indicated in Section 5, when applicable. Please note this list is subject to change, please call to verify if your procedure requires preauthorization. Refer to the back of your member ID card under the heading Prior Authorization for the contact information.

Services requiring preauthorization or medical necessity determination may be reviewed with guidelines as described at geha.com/Coverage-Criteria. G.E.H.A has coverage policies for many services and procedures; refer to geha.com/Provider-Policies for a complete list of policies.

Transplants services require more extensive reviews. The transplant must be performed in a designated transplant facility to receive maximum benefits.

If precertification is not obtained or a Plan-designated transplant facility is not used, our allowance will be limited for hospital and surgery expenses up to a maximum of $100,000 per transplant. If we cannot refer a member in need of a transplant to a designated facility, the $100,000 maximum will not apply.

- Tandem bone marrow transplants approved as one treatment protocol are limited to $100,000 when not performed at a Plan-designated facility. All treatment within 120 days following the transplant is subject to the $100,000 limit. Outpatient prescription drugs are not a part of the $100,000 limit.
- Simultaneous transplants such as kidney/pancreas, heart/lung, heart/liver are considered as one transplant procedure and are limited to $100,000 when not performed at a Plan-designated transplant facility.
- Chemotherapy and procedures related to bone marrow transplantation must be performed only at a Plan-designated transplant facility to receive maximum benefits.

If benefits are limited to $100,000 per transplant, included in the maximum are all charges for hospital, medical and surgical care incurred while the patient is hospitalized for a covered transplant surgery and subsequent complications related to the transplant. Outpatient expenses for chemotherapy and any process of obtaining stem cells or bone marrow associated with bone marrow transplant (stem cell support) are included in benefits limit of $100,000 per transplant.

How to request precertification for an admission for Other services

First, you, your representative, your physician, or your facility must call to obtain preauthorization before an inpatient facility admission, Residential Treatment Center (RTC) admission, or for services requiring precertification/preauthorization are rendered. Refer to the back of your member ID card under the heading Prior Authorization for the contact information.

For admissions to Skilled Nursing Facility, Long-Term Acute Care, or Rehabilitation facilities, please refer to the back of your member ID card under the heading Prior Authorization for the contact information.

Next, provide the following information:

- enrollee’s name and plan identification number;
- patient’s name, birth date, and phone number;